

Shavuot

חג השבועות – תשפ"ה

Rabbi Shalom Rosner ♦ Na'aseh VeNishma

At the heart of Matan Torah are three interlocking ideas: **why did Am Yisrael respond as one**, why did the nations think Sinai was a Mabul, and what kind of Achdus is truly new in the world? These highlights follow Rabbi Rosner's Shavuot shiur through each of those threads.

1 • Na'aseh VeNishma — We Will Do and We Will Hear

Reb Bunim of Peshischa asks: why *lashon rabbim* — plural? A'aseh VeEshma ("I will do and hear") would be the personal, individual response. How did every person know what every other person was thinking? His mashal: prisoners denied water for days. When the warden finally brings a barrel, they do not say "Yes, I'll take some." They cry out: **"We want water!"** — spontaneously, collectively. At Sinai, the clarity of Hashem's presence was so overwhelming that the response was inevitably communal.

נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע
(שמות כד:ז)

0:12 — Reb Bunim of Peshischa

2 • Matan Torah Confused for a Mabul

Zevachim 116a: When the thunder, lightning, and *kolos* of Sinai broke over the world, the nations fled in terror to Bilam HaRasha. *"Is there another Mabul?"* Bilam replies: Hashem promised no more Mabul of water. *"Perhaps a Mabul of fire?"* He promises no Mabul of any kind. *"Then what is this?"* — **Hashem is giving the Torah to Am Yisrael.**

ה' עוז לעמו יתן ה' יברך את עמו בשלום
(תהלים כט:יא)

The nations' reaction was not random. They saw at Sinai an Achdus they had witnessed only once before — on the Teiva. And they drew the natural but mistaken conclusion. 1:31 — Zevachim 116a / Rav Meir Shapiro

3 • Two Types of Achdus

Rav Meir Shapiro explains: Yeshayahu Navi prophesies that in the days of Mashiach, wolves and sheep will dwell together — unprecedented Achdus. But wait — didn't that happen once before? On the Teiva, all the animals lived peaceably together.

What is Yeshayahu describing that has *never* happened before?

Type 1 — Achdus from necessity: When you have no choice, when there is a common threat, even enemies cooperate. That is what happened on the Teiva. **Type 2 — Achdus from shared vision:** Unity rooted in a common

dream, shared aspiration, a collective *ratzion* to live Devar Hashem. That kind of Achdus — Yeshayahu says — will characterise the end of days. And it has happened only once: at Matan Torah.

אַחְדוּת מִתּוֹךְ אֵין בְּרָרָה
לְעֵמֶת
אַחְדוּת מִתּוֹךְ חֲזוֹן מְשׁוֹתָף

2:48 — Rav Meir Shapiro / Yeshayahu 11:6

וַיִּחַן שָׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל נֶגֶד הָהָר כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלִבֹּאֶחָד

Rashi, Shemot 19:2 — The unity at Sinai was not forced; it was vision-unity.

4 • A True Kabbalas HaTorah

The shiur closes with a blessing and a challenge. The Achdus of Matan Torah was not survival-Achdus — it was *vision-Achdus*: every person at Sinai experienced Hashem so individually and so collectively that *Na'aseh VeNishma* was the only possible response.

“Let each of us be Zocheh to experience Torah not as an obligation but as living water — the way a prisoner who has gone without water for days experiences the first drink. And B'ezrat Hashem, let us work toward the day that all of Am Yisrael will be inspired by those divine visions every single day.”

לְכֹל אֶחָד בְּדַרְכּוֹ הַמְּיֻחָדָת
Each person — in his own unique way.

3:56 — Closing bracha

נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע

“We will do, and we will hear.” (Shemot 24:7)